

Vo9 Virtual Financial Portfolio Management Team

Description & Eligibility

Teams will enter an investment simulation using an online platform provided by a BPA partner. The simulation will provide the students with \$100,000 initially, to be used to invest in stocks, mutual funds, and/or bonds. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Any middle level, secondary or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. Teams who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic (*Top 20 contestants from Round 1 only*)

You have just accepted a job as a financial advisor with a major brokerage firm. On your first day at work, a 19-year-old walks in and says he just inherited \$100,000. He just started college and needs to invest \$60,000 conservatively over the next 4 years so he can pay for college, but he wants to make as much money as he can on the other \$40k over the next 5 years so he can buy a car and maybe a down payment on a house a year or two after graduates from college. What will you suggest to him?

The initial \$100,000 MUST be used to purchase the following:

- Students must purchase at least \$8,000-\$10,000 of shares in at least 5 different stocks each in a different industry (i.e., diversify!)by 3:59 pm ET on Friday, December 19, 2026, and hold at least 5 of these original stocks for the entire time of the stock market simulation
- Two of these five stocks must have a dividend yield greater than 3%
- Teams MUST purchase and hold \$10,000 in mutual funds by 3:59 pm ET on Friday, December 19, 2026, and hold at least \$10,000 in a mutual fund for the entire time of the stock market simulation
 - Teams who advance to round two presentations should be prepared to explain why they picked the stocks that they did
- Teams may use the remaining \$40,000 to purchase (no shorting) additional stocks, ETFs or mutual funds.
- All stocks must have a minimum price of \$10 per share
- Teams may buy and sell these stocks as they wish, with each transaction subject to a \$10 commission fee which will be subtracted their cash balance
- Teams can buy any investment allowed through the NYSE and NASDAQ markets, including stocks, mutual funds, and bonds
- Teams will be limited on any one investment to 10% of their portfolio
- Teams will be allowed to buy on margin up to 100% of their cash balance. Any loan will be charged 8% interest
- Teams will receive 3% interest on any cash balance maintained
- Teams MUST make a minimum of six purchases by December 19th to be eligible for placement.
- If you qualify for a presentation, you must clearly state the 5 stocks and 1 mutual fund that you purchased and held, the performance and industry of each, and why you chose those 6 securities

Competition Notes

- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register teams for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>
 - Click on the "Conferences" tab and then select the "2027 National Virtual Events"
 - There will be a \$20 fee for each team entry (*invoiced during event registration*)
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after member registration
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2026
 - Teams participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible

Contest Competencies

1. Research and analyze various investment options, evaluating cash and asset allocation strategies to maximize return within given restrictions
2. Calculate investment amounts and return on investments, applying relevant formulas and financial concepts to assess performance and value
3. Manage an online investment fund, applying real-world decision-making to monitor and adjust holdings over time
4. Determine the timing of buying and selling investments by interpreting market trends, economic indicators, and relevant financial factors
5. Prepare investment reports using spreadsheet software to organize, calculate, and present financial data in a clear and professional format
6. Develop and deliver a presentation of investment strategies, communicating findings, rationale, and recommendations to a professional audience

Contest Specifications for this Event

- All registered teams will participate in a virtual stock market challenge. Tutorials and login credentials will be emailed to registered teams by early December 2026.
- The top twenty (20) teams, in terms of portfolio value, will be invited to design a computer-generated multimedia presentation on their strategies for success and challenges faced. The presentation should make effective use of current multimedia technology (e.g., sound, movement, digital video, etc.).
- Advisors of qualifying teams will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Teams will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- Teams with the highest cumulative presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered contestants and/or those missing Team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

This event is sponsored by:



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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Opening & Summary	Introduction is unclear or missing, and the summary lacks relevance or completeness.	Introduction sets the stage; summary clearly covers main points.	Introduction is engaging; summary clearly reinforces key insights.	/20
Investment Strategy	The strategy is vague, lacks coherence, or does not align with the portfolio’s goals.	The strategy is clearly stated, logically structured, and appropriately supports the portfolio’s objectives.	Strategy is well-justified and shows strong grasp of investment principles and goals.	/20
Technical Language	Technical terms are misused, overused, or lack clear explanation, making the content difficult to follow.	Technical terms are used appropriately and are explained well enough for general understanding.	Technical terms are used precisely and effectively, with clear, insightful explanations that enhance understanding.	/20
Financial Understanding	The strategy and research show limited financial understanding, with weak or unsupported analysis.	The strategy and research demonstrate sound financial knowledge and are reasonably supported by relevant analysis.	The strategy and research reflect strong financial expertise, with thorough, well-supported analysis and clear insight.	/20
Visual Design	Visual elements are distracting, inconsistent, or poorly integrated, reducing clarity and impact.	Typography and graphics are appropriately used and contribute to a clear, professional presentation.	Visual elements are polished, well-balanced, and enhance the message with strong visual appeal and clarity.	/20
Presentation Delivery	Delivery lacks clarity or confidence, with poor diction, limited eye contact, or distracting vocal qualities.	Delivery is clear and professional, with appropriate diction, steady eye contact, and confident voice.	Delivery is polished and engaging, with strong vocal presence, precise diction, and consistent, natural eye contact.	/20
Judges’ Questions	Responses lack depth; presenter shows limited understanding of topic.	Responses lack detail or clarity; understanding is partial.	Responses are confident, detailed, and insightful.	/20
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/155

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES